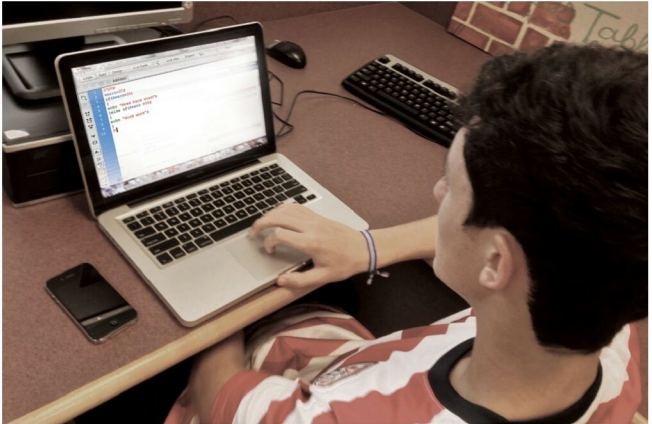


Wish to Standardise Your Code?

Use PHP CodeSniffer

Coding standards are imperative to ensure good, clean code. Typically, code for a project is not a single person's effort and it tends to deteriorate over time, so much so that developers often cannot read their own code. To prevent this, coding standards must be prescribed and rigidly followed. Read on to learn more about the PHP CodeSniffer (PHPCS), a software tool to help you keep a check on coding standards.



PHP is considered by many to be the topmost server side programming language, and is getting more popular due to its wide range of functions and its simplicity. There are many websites and Web applications emerging every day that use PHP, as it suits a wide range of requirements - from simple Web pages to giant websites like Facebook, Wikipedia, Yahoo, etc.

Owing to wide usage, there is also a need for the maintenance of the code. The first and most important concern is to maintain the code by following proper coding standards. A few reasons why it is necessary to follow coding standards are:

- Most of the time, code does not belong to a single person. A team is usually involved in the development of code.
- Typically, open source projects are developed by many

people who have different levels of experience.

- Coding standards enable fast knowledge transfer to a new person on the team at minimal cost.
- After some time, it is difficult even for the developer to understand the code for bug fixing or upgradation, if coding standards are not followed.

Most programmers are aware about these challenges and agree on the importance of coding standards.

In reality, when a project is kickstarted, everybody agrees to follow coding standards but as the project moves forward, programmers slowly digress from these. At some point of time in the project, if you check the coding standards, you will find them at the document level but not at the code level!

The will to strictly follow coding standards diminishes